

Glossary of Key Terms - Nutrition in Health, Exercise and Sport Conditioning

Term	Definition
Macronutrients	Nutrients needed in large amounts: carbohydrates, protein, fat
Micronutrients	Vitamins and minerals needed in small amounts
Carbohydrates	Primary energy source for exercise
Protein	Builds and repairs muscle tissue
Fats	Long-term energy source and hormone support
Calories	Unit of energy from food
Energy Balance	Calories consumed vs. calories burned
Basal Metabolic Rate (BMR)	Energy used at rest
Total Daily Energy Expenditure (TDEE)	Total energy used daily
Glycogen	Stored carbohydrate in muscles/liver
Glucose	Blood sugar used for energy
Insulin	Hormone regulating blood glucose
Gluconeogenesis	Creation of glucose from non-carbohydrate sources
Lipids	Fats and oils in the body
Triglycerides	Main form of stored fat
Cholesterol	Fat-like substance in cells and blood
Omega-3 Fatty Acids	Anti-inflammatory fats from fish
Saturated Fat	Solid fat linked to heart disease
Unsaturated Fat	Healthier fat found in plants
Trans Fat	Artificial fat harmful to health
Amino Acids	Building blocks of protein
Essential Amino Acids	Must be obtained from diet
Branched-Chain Amino Acids (BCAAs)	Key amino acids for muscle
Creatine	Supplement for strength and power
Hydration	Maintaining fluid balance
Electrolytes	Minerals regulating fluid and muscle function
Sodium	Key electrolyte for hydration
Potassium	Electrolyte for muscle and nerve function
Magnesium	Supports energy and muscle function
Calcium	Important for bones and muscle contraction
Iron	Carries oxygen in blood
Haemoglobin	Oxygen-carrying protein in red blood cells
Anaemia	Low iron levels affecting performance
Vitamin D	Supports bone health and immunity
Vitamin C	Antioxidant and immune support
Antioxidants	Protect cells from damage
Free Radicals	Harmful molecules from stress/exercise
Oxidative Stress	Imbalance of free radicals and antioxidants
Fibre	Aids digestion and satiety
Digestion	Breakdown of food into nutrients
Absorption	Uptake of nutrients into bloodstream
Metabolism	Chemical processes for energy and growth
Catabolism	Breakdown of molecules for energy
Anabolism	Building of molecules like muscle

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Thermic Effect of Food (TEF)	Energy used to digest food
Meal Timing	Scheduling meals for performance
Pre-Workout Nutrition	Fuel before exercise
Post-Workout Nutrition	Recovery nutrients after exercise
Recovery	Time for body to repair and adapt
Supplementation	Use of additional nutrients
Ergogenic Aids	Substances enhancing performance
Caffeine	Stimulant improving alertness and endurance
Beta-Alanine	Buffering agent for high-intensity exercise
Nitrate	Found in beetroot; boosts endurance
Sports Drinks	Provide carbohydrates and electrolytes
Isotonic Drinks	Match body's fluid concentration
Hypotonic Drinks	Lower concentration for quick hydration
Hypertonic Drinks	Higher concentration for energy
Dehydration	Loss of fluids impairing performance
Sweat Rate	Fluid loss during exercise
Body Composition	Ratio of fat to lean mass
BMI (Body Mass Index)	Weight-to-height ratio
Skinfold Measurements	Assess body fat
DEXA Scan	Measures bone density and body composition
Energy Availability	Energy left after exercise for body functions
Relative Energy Deficiency in Sport (RED-S)	Low energy affecting health
Female Athlete Triad	Disordered eating, amenorrhoea, low bone density
Periodisation	Planned variation in training and nutrition
Tapering	Reducing training before competition
Peaking	Reaching optimal performance
Overtraining	Excessive training without recovery
Fatigue	Decline in performance
Sleep	Essential for recovery and adaptation
Circadian Rhythm	Body's internal clock
Gut Health	Digestive system function and microbiome
Probiotics	Beneficial bacteria for gut health
Food Labels	Nutritional information on packaging
Allergens	Substances causing allergic reactions
Intolerances	Difficulty digesting certain foods
Nutrition Strategy	Planned approach to fuelling performance